SQL Server 2025 Express

Installation Guide

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Download SQL Server

microsoft.com

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Basic Edition

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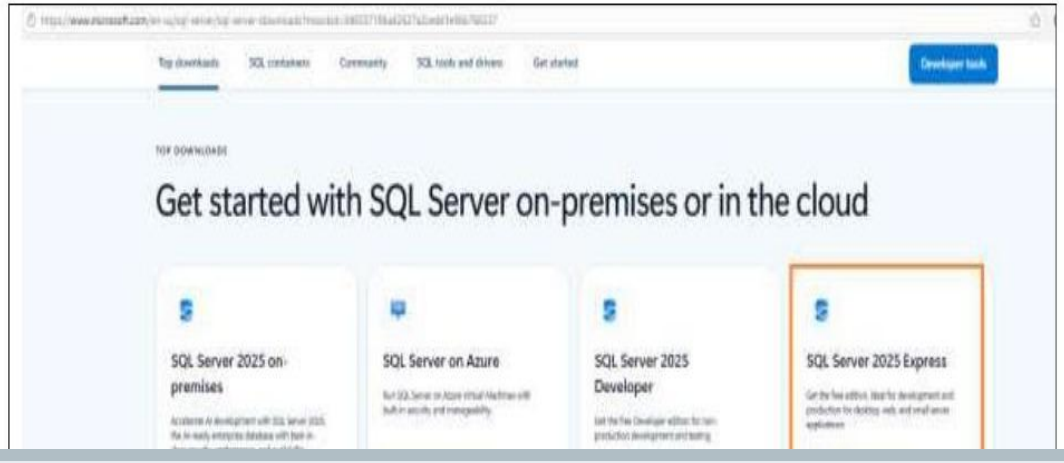
Object Explorer

01

Download SQL Server 2025

Get the free Express edition from Microsoft

01 Step 1 — Go to Microsoft SQL Server Downloads



1. Visit microsoft.com/sql-server/downloads
2. Four edition options shown
3. Select SQL Server 2025 Express — free edition
4. Click Download now to get the installer

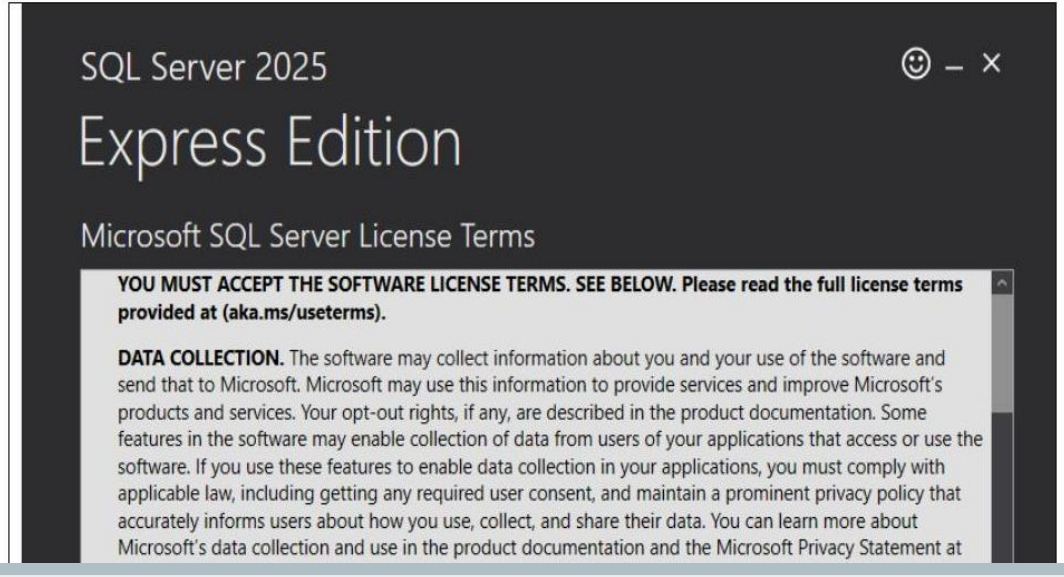
💡 SQL Server 2025 Express is free for development, desktop, web and small server use. No licence cost.

01 Step 2 — Choose Installation Type: Basic

1. Three options: Basic, Custom, Download Media
2. Click Basic for default configuration
3. Installs SQL Engine with default settings
4. Fastest path to a working instance

💡 Basic installs the SQL Server Database Engine with default configuration — ideal for learners.

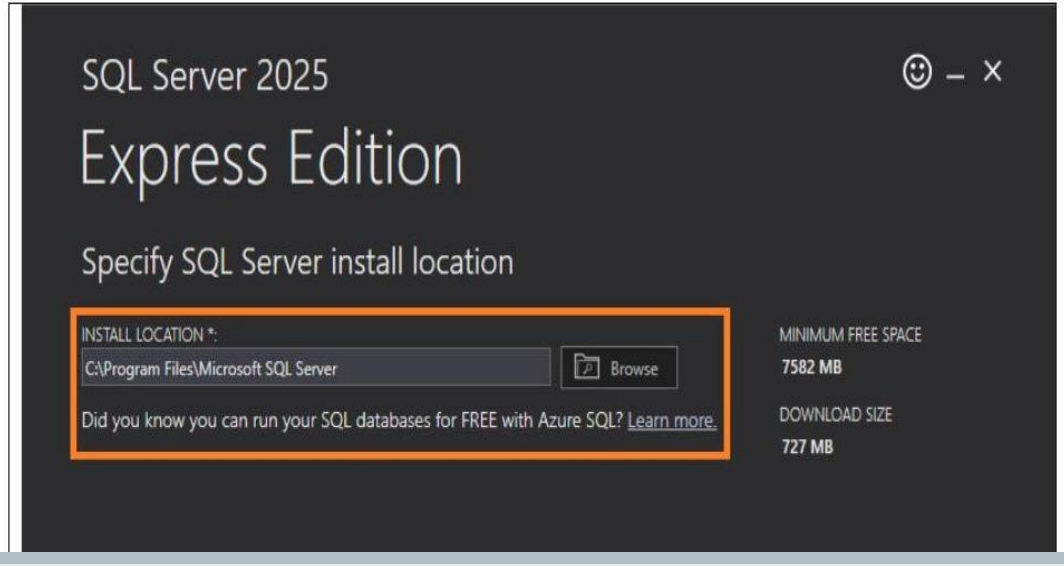
01 Step 3 — Accept the License Terms



1. Read the Microsoft Software License Terms
2. Note the Data Collection notice
3. Click Accept to continue installation
4. Version shown: 17.0.1000.7

💡 You can turn off data collection after installation — see the Microsoft privacy documentation link on this screen.

01 Step 4 — Specify Install Location



1. Default: C:\Program Files\Microsoft SQL Server
2. Use Browse to change if needed
3. Minimum free space required: 7,582 MB
4. Download size: 727 MB — ensure stable internet

💡 Keep the default install path unless your C: drive is low on space. Click Install to begin the download.

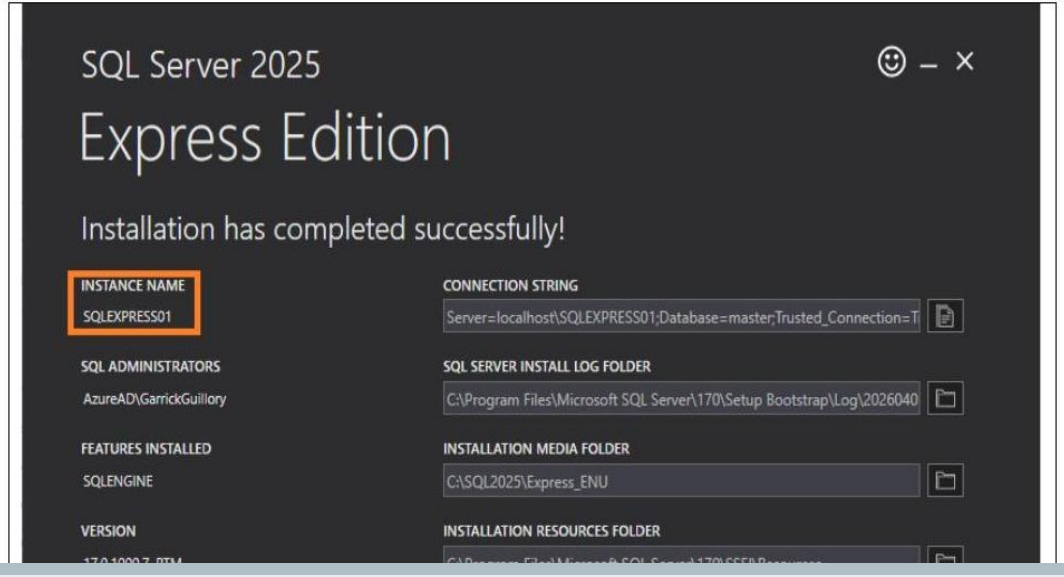
01 Step 5 — Downloading the Install Package

1. Installer downloads ~714 MB
2. Progress bar shows download status
3. SQL Server 2025 also available for Linux
4. Use Pause if you need to pause the download

💡 Download time depends on your connection. On a 100 Mbps line this takes approximately 60–90 seconds.

01

Step 6 — Installation Complete!



1. Instance name: SQLEXPRESS01
2. Connection string shown — copy it now
3. Features installed: SQLENGINE
4. Version: 17.0.1000.7, RTM
5. Click Install SSMS to continue

💡 Copy the connection string before closing. You'll need it when connecting from SSMS or your applications.

02

Install SSMS

SQL Server Management Studio 22

02 Step 7 — Microsoft Learn: Install SSMS

https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/ssms/install/install?redirectedfrom=MSDN

Find by title

- Microsoft SQL documentation >
- SQL Server Management Studio documentation
- Overview
- Components and features
- Installation and support
  - Release notes
  - Known issues
  - Product roadmap
  - System requirements
  - Installation
    - Download and install
    - Select installation location
    - Install with command-line parameters
    - Command-line parameter examples
    - Workload and component IDs
    - Create an offline installation
    - Install certificates
    - Install versions side-by-side
    - Install local help documentation
    - Update
    - Modify
    - Repair
    - Uninstall
    - Troubleshoot installation issues
  - Channels
  - Release history

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Learn / SQL Server Management Studio / Ask Learn Focus mode

Install SQL Server Management Studio

Summarize this article for me

Applies to: SQL Server Azure SQL Database Azure SQL Managed Instance Azure Synapse Analytics Analytics Platform System (PDW) SQL analytics endpoint in Microsoft Fabric Warehouse in Microsoft Fabric SQL database in Microsoft Fabric

SQL Server Management Studio (SSMS) is an integrated environment for managing any SQL infrastructure. Use SSMS to access, configure, manage, administer, and develop all components of your Database Engine.

This article describes how to install the latest version of SSMS.

Download SQL Server Management Studio 22 installer

Installation overview

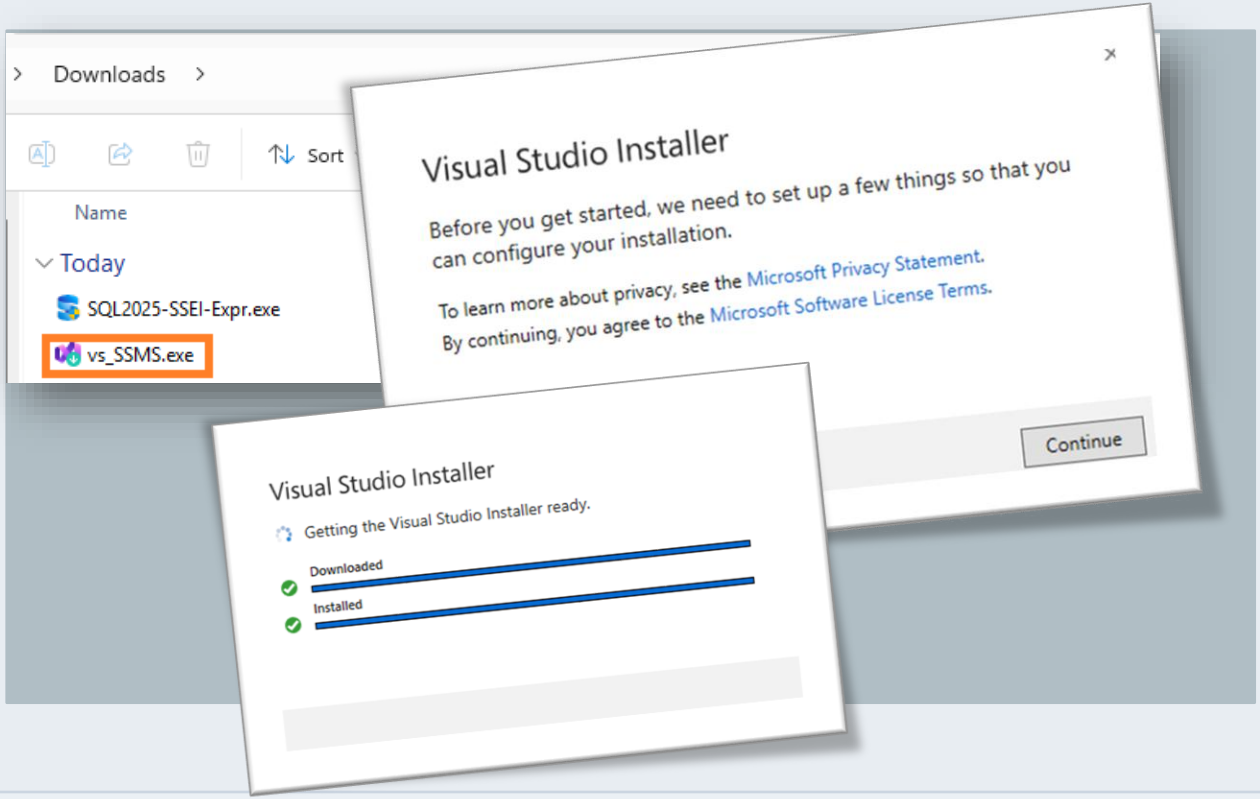
Expand table

Key information	Action required
SSMS 22 is installed with the Visual Studio Installer	The **SSMS 22 installer** link downloads a stub installer (`vs_SSMS.exe`) that opens **Visual Studio Installer** to install SSMS. There's no standalone MSI.
How to install SSMS	Download the SSMS 22 installer, run `vs_SSMS.exe`, pick any optional workloads/components, then select **Install**.
Use the Visual Studio Installer to update SSMS 22	To update SSMS 22, follow the instructions in Update SQL Server Management Studio.
Offline or enterprise deployment	To create an offline layout for disconnected or managed installs, see Create an offline installation of SQL Server Management Studio.
Database Engine compatibility	SSMS 22 works with SQL Server 2014 (12.x) and later versions. If you need to manage older versions, see the Release history. SSMS 22 also works with Azure SQL Database, Azure SQL Managed Instance, Azure Synapse Analytics, and SQL database in Microsoft Fabric.

1. Visit learn.microsoft.com/ssms
2. SSMS 22 is installed via Visual Studio Installer
3. Works with SQL Server 2014 and later
4. Also supports Azure SQL and Synapse
5. Click the Download SSMS 22 installer button

💡 SSMS 22 is a free integrated environment for managing SQL Server, Azure SQL, and Microsoft Fabric.

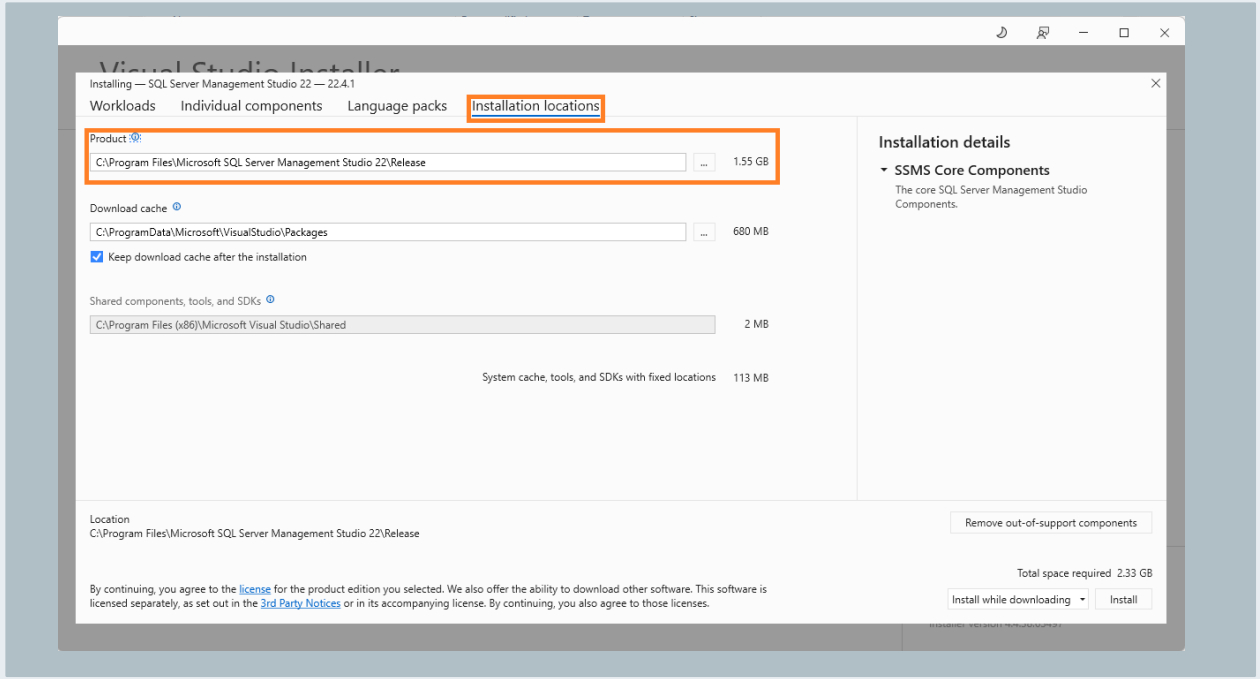
02 Step 8 — Launch the SSMS Installer (vs_SSMS.exe)



1. Two files in Downloads folder
2. Double-click vs_SSMS.exe (4,347 KB)
3. Visual Studio Installer sets up first
4. Click Continue to agree to privacy terms
5. Downloaded and Installed bars fill green

The SSMS installer runs through the Visual Studio Installer framework. This is normal — click Continue.

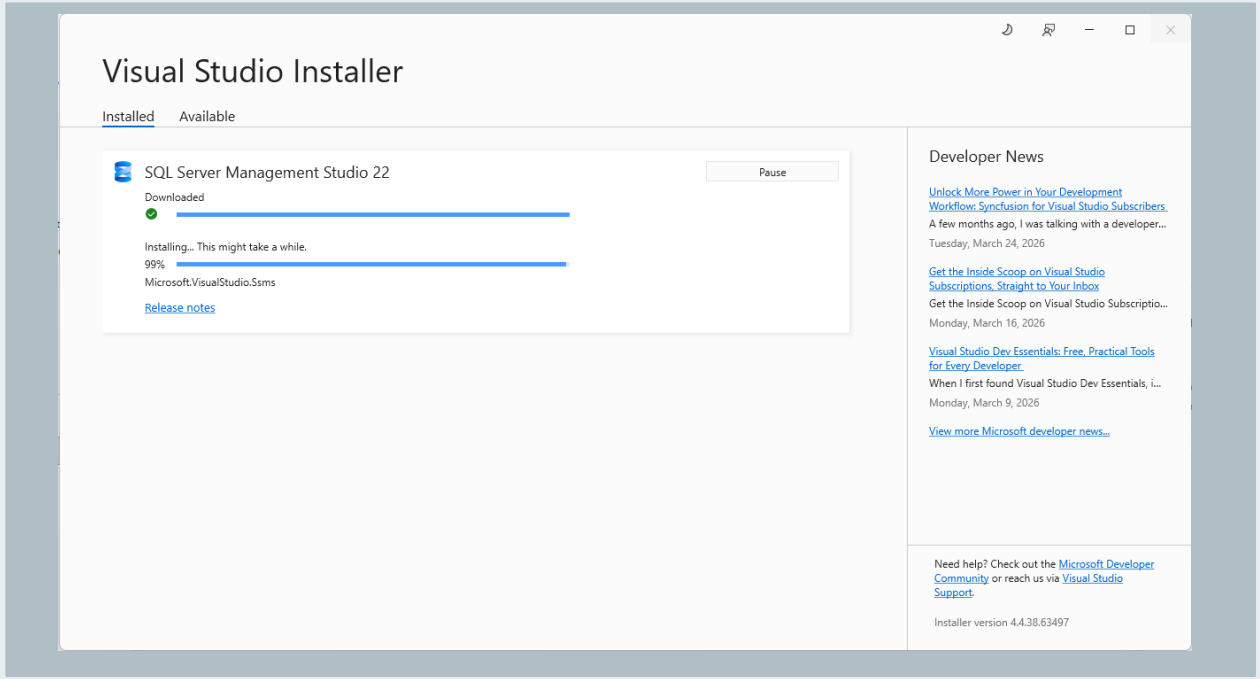
02 Step 9 — Configure Installation Locations



1. Go to Installation Locations tab
2. Product: C:\Program Files\Microsoft SQL Server Management Studio 22\Release
3. Total space required: 2.33 GB
4. Check Install while downloading checkbox
5. Click Install to begin

💡 Ensure you have at least 2.5 GB free on your C: drive before clicking Install.

02 Step 10 — SSMS Installing (99% → Complete)



1. Installing SQL Server Management Studio 22
2. Progress reaches 99% — this may take a few minutes
3. Second panel shows All installations are up to date
4. SSMS 22.4.1 successfully installed
5. Click Launch to open SSMS immediately

💡 Installation takes 5–10 minutes depending on your machine. Do not restart or close the installer during this step.

03

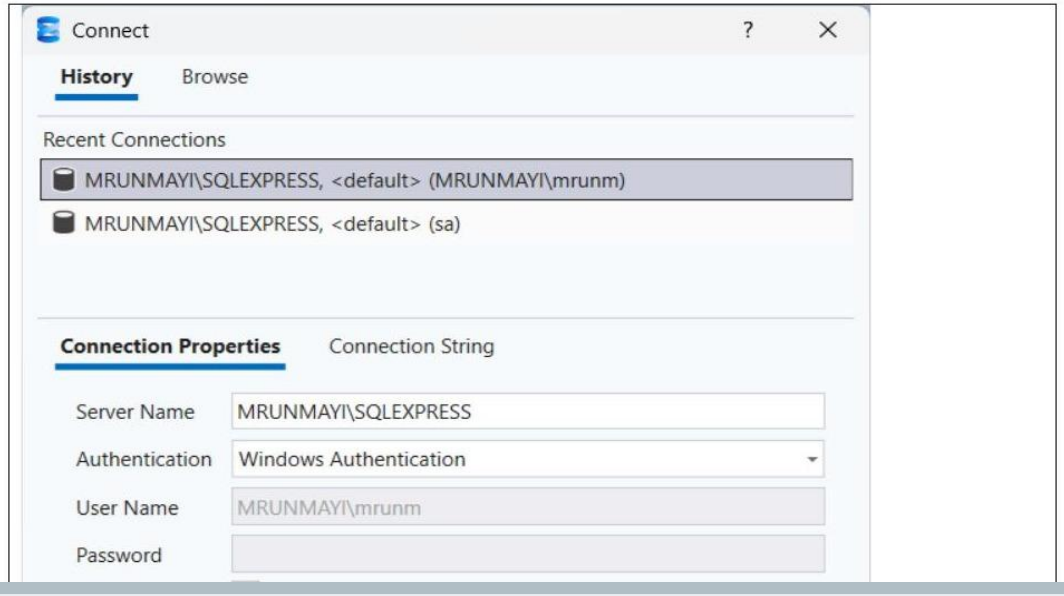
Connect to SQL Server

Verify your installation with SSMS

Step 11 — SQL Server Management Studio Launches

💡 SSMS 22 splash screen. If SSMS does not open automatically, find it in Start → SQL Server Management Studio 22

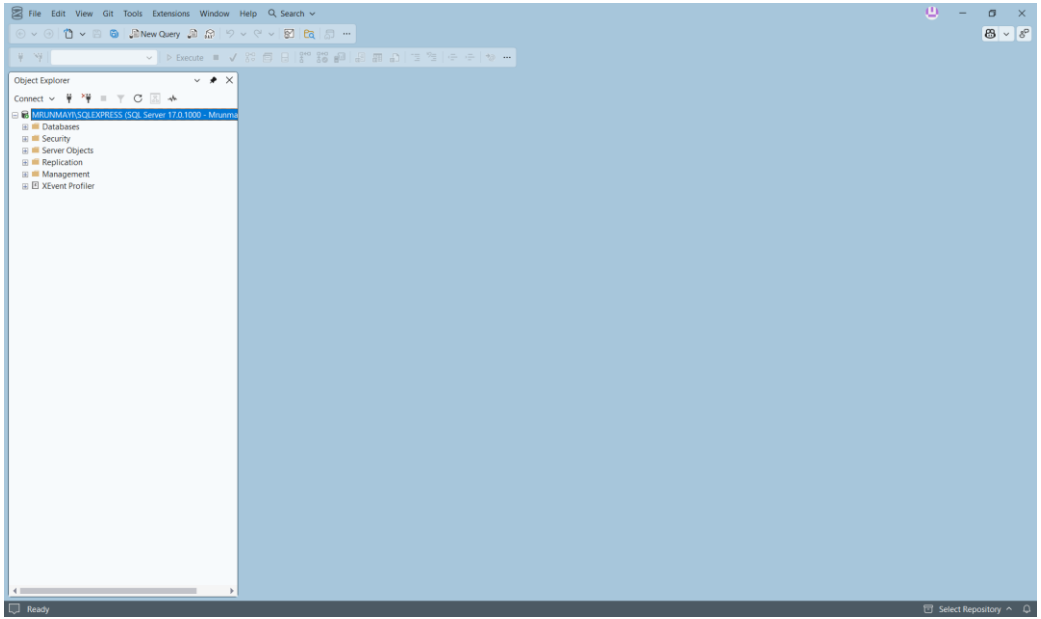
03 Step 12 — Connect to Server Dialog



1. Server Name: MRUNMAYI\SQLEXPRESS
2. Authentication: Windows Authentication
3. User populated automatically from Windows login
4. Click Connect (highlighted in pink)
5. Encryption: Optional — safe for local dev

💡 Use Windows Authentication for local connections. Your Windows username is automatically populated — no password needed.

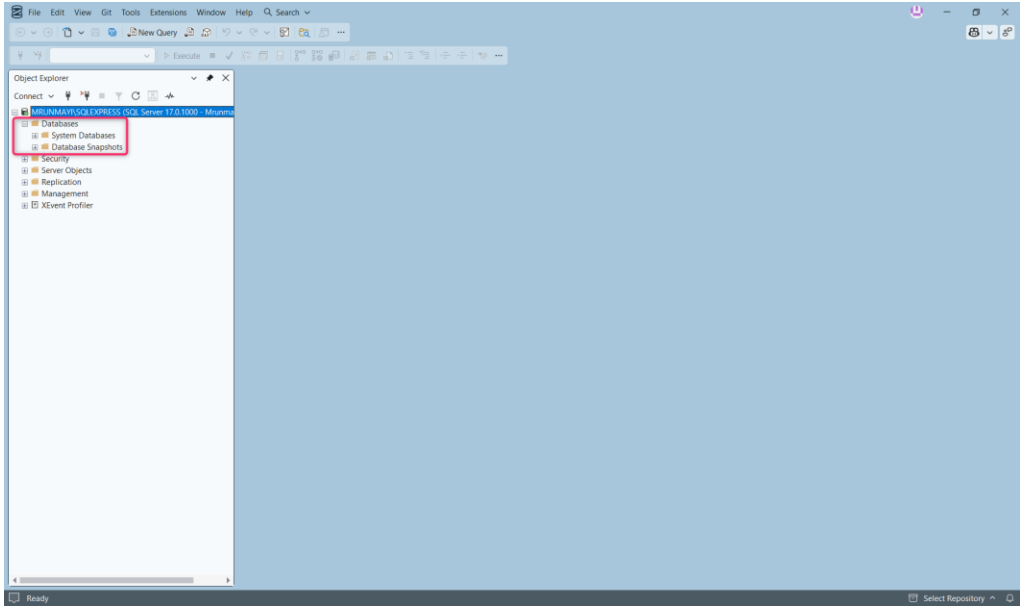
03 Step 13 — Connected! Object Explorer Open



1. Left panel shows Object Explorer
2. Server node shows as connected (green)
3. Expand Databases to see system DBs
4. New Query button available in toolbar
5. You are now ready to write T-SQL

💡 If Object Explorer is empty, click the + next to your server name to expand. You should see Databases, Security, Server Objects.

03 Step 14 — Explore Databases in Object Explorer



1. Databases node expanded (highlighted)
2. System Databases visible underneath
3. Database Snapshots folder shown
4. Security, Server Objects, Replication visible
5. Right-click Databases to create a new DB

💡 Your SQL Server installation is complete and working. Next: restore the AdventureWorksLT 2022 sample database for the course.

References & Next Steps

SQL Server 2025 Express Download

microsoft.com/en-us/sql-server/sql-server-downloads

Introduction to T-SQL — Microsoft Learn

learn.microsoft.com/training/paths/get-started-querying-with-transact-sql

Install SSMS — Microsoft Learn

learn.microsoft.com/en-us/sql/ssms/install

SQL Server 2025 Workshop

github.com/microsoft/sqlworkshops-sql2022workshop

AdventureWorksLT Sample DB

github.com/microsoft/sql-server-samples

DP-900 Exam — Azure Data Fundamentals

learn.microsoft.com/credentials/certifications/azure-data-fundamentals